

4.9 GRADE DESCRIPTIONS

Grade descriptions are provided to give a general indication of the standards of achievement likely to have been shown by the candidates awarded particular grades. The descriptions must be interpreted in relation to the content specified in Section 5; they are not designed to define that content. The grade awarded will depend in practice upon the extent to which the candidate has met the assessment objectives overall. Shortcomings in some aspects of the assessment may be balanced by better performance in others.

Grade F

Candidates demonstrate knowledge and understanding of some aspects of the specification content. They begin to apply this knowledge and understanding, using some terms, concepts, theories and methods to address problems and issues. They show some ability to select, organise, interpret and use simple information from a variety of sources to analyse problems and issues. They also make judgements and present simple conclusions that are sometimes supported by evidence.

Grade C

Candidates demonstrate knowledge and understanding of most aspects of the specification content. They apply this knowledge and understanding, using terms, concepts, theories and methods appropriately to address problems and issues. They select, organise, interpret and use information from a variety of sources to analyse problems and issues with some accuracy. They also make reasoned judgements and present conclusions that are supported by evidence.

Grade A

Candidates demonstrate in-depth knowledge and critical understanding of the full range of specification content. They apply this knowledge and critical understanding, using terms, concepts, theories and methods effectively to address problems and issues. They select and organise information from a wide variety of sources and interpret and use this information effectively to analyse problems and issues with a high degree of accuracy. They also evaluate evidence effectively, making reasoned judgements and presenting conclusions accurately and appropriately.

SECTION C: SPECIFICATION CONTENT

5 Specification Content

The content of this specification should be taught in the context of the assessment objectives and in particular of the requirement that candidates should be able to demonstrate specified knowledge and understanding of the basic economic problems and decisions which give rise to economics as a discipline. It is essential that the range of content given below be demonstrated in the context of the interdependent economic behaviour of individuals, groups, organisations and governments within local, national, European and international contexts.

The order in which the specification content is presented does not imply a proposed teaching order. Indeed, the integration of the different sections of this specification is essential.

Economics should not be taught in isolation from the real world and the community at large. Throughout the course, the dynamic nature of economic activity should be emphasised, with particular reference to the UK economy. Candidates must appreciate the perspectives of a range of stakeholders in relation to the environment, individuals, society, government and enterprise.

The course aims and objectives should be understood by candidates, together with the setting of personal targets and the improvement of their own learning, and this should be encouraged.

Each of the following statements is pre-fixed by the stem 'Candidates should be able to...'. For each statement one key action verb is used (e.g. describe, identify, explain, evaluate), but others may also be important.